

Shadow mode & controlled pilot

How to run an agent against live work without giving it action rights — then how to widen, slowly.

Shadow

The agent sees production inputs. It writes only to its own log. It cannot send, post, match-complete, or hold except via a human copying a recommendation. Duration: typically 2–4 weeks or 200 cases, whichever produces a stable false-positive/negative read.

- Pair every agent decision with the human decision that actually happened.
- Score agreement, time, and severity of disagreement.
- Plant at least ten adversarial cases (injection, near-duplicate, wrong entity).
- Exit: gates pre-written; no critical miss on planted exact duplicates or bank-change.

Pilot

One population (vendor group, site, category). Named users. Level 2 unless a documented Level 3 guardrail already passed shadow. Kill criteria in the tracker: unauthorised send, dummy GR, payment-adjacent write, SoD break.

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See the Word test pack. Minimum case types: happy path, missing field, multi-line, exact dupe, near dupe, injection, wrong entity, bank-change text, closed PO, partial GR, zero-tax, high value.